The DO Application

Everything you need for the 2026–2027 AACOMAS cycle

Due dates · Ryan Gray tips · Your school list

Built from Ryan Gray's *Premed Playbook* · AACOM official 2026-27 data · your reapplication plan

THE RULE THAT MATTERS MOST

DO isn't your backup.

Your grandfather practiced medicine in Surat. Your **Medical Anthropology** minor at UNC taught you that health lives inside family, work, and context. Your year as an MA at Medi-Weightloss proved you can show up for patients daily. *That is osteopathic philosophy.*

Srishti Calibration · CLAUDE.md Rule #1

Never frame DO as a backup. Never apologize for choosing osteopathic medicine. Lead with genuine alignment.

WHAT IS A DO, ACTUALLY?

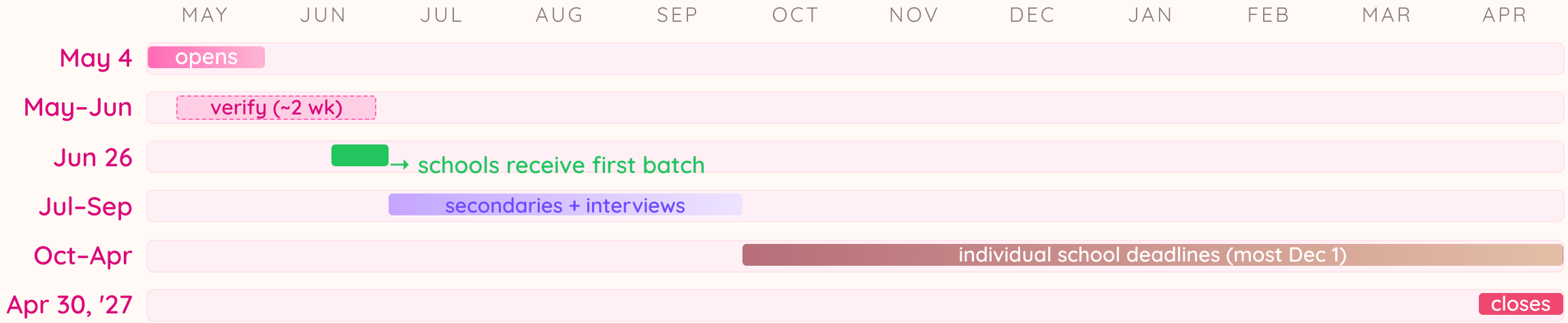
MD vs DO — the differences that matter

DIMENSION	MD · Allopathic	DO · Osteopathic
Application service	AMCAS	AACOMAS
Medical licensure (U.S.)	Full MD license	Full DO license
Residency match (merged ACGME)	Same pool	Same pool
Extra training	—	OMT · 200 hrs hands-on
Matriculant MCAT median	511	504
Matriculant GPA median	3.73 / 3.66	3.54 / 3.48

Source: AACOMAS 2025 matriculant data + Ryan Gray, Premed Playbook, School List chapter

THE 2026–2027 AACOMAS TIMELINE

From opening day to final deadline



Source: AACOM official 2026-27 cycle page · Liaison AACOMAS verification FAQ

YOUR TARGET SUBMIT WINDOW

Early June. No slippage.

APR 17–30

Polish PS

Rewrite — same seed, new stories. PA/NP LOR asked.

MAY 4

Submit

AACOMAS opens. Submit within 48 hours of opening.

JUN 1

Verified

~4 week buffer absorbed. Transcript matched, comp calc done.

JUN 26

Transmit

First batch to schools. Secondaries start landing within days.

Gray's rule: "Submit in the first few weeks. Late application = your first failed test of medical school." You missed this in Cycle 1. Not again.

AACOMAS VS AMCAS

The differences that change your workflow

FEATURE	AMCAS · MD	AACOMAS · DO
Personal statement limit	5,300 char	5,300 char
Activity slots	15 (hard cap)	Unlimited
Activity description limit	700 char	600 char
Most-meaningful bonus	✓ 3 × 1,325	×
Verification turnaround	~4 weeks	~2 weeks
Repeated-course GPA calc	Both attempts count	Grade replacement
Letters required	2 sci + 1 non-sci	Varies · DO letter useful, rarely required

FROM THE PLAYBOOK

7 Ryan Gray rules.

— calibrated to a 517, Canadian, reapplicant you.

TIP 1 & 2

1 Apply to both.

Gray: *"Apply broadly. Apply to both MD and DO."* Your 517 opens MD doors that most DO-track students can't touch. Your Canadian status closes half the MD list — which is exactly why DO **adds** leverage, not replaces it.

📖 *Premed Playbook · School List ch. · ~line 3100*

2 You don't need a DO letter.

Gray: *"Only two schools require a letter from a DO."* Nice-to-have if you find one shadowing, not a dealbreaker. **Your PA/NP letter from Medi-Weightloss** remains your primary clinical LOR.

📖 *LOR chapter · ~line 2855 · Calibration: CLAUDE.md Rule #5*

TIP 3 & 4

3 Never say "holistic philosophy."

❌ THE CLICHÉ GRAY ROASTS

"I believe in the holistic approach to medicine..."

✅ DO THIS INSTEAD

Name a **DO you shadowed**, a technique you watched, a specific patient moment. Personal anecdote > philosophy word.

4 Yield protection is real.

Gray: *"DO schools may not invite a student with a 517 MCAT — they assume you'll go MD."*

YOUR DEFENSE

Every "Why this DO school?" essay must prove genuine intent: **specific programs · faculty · mission language · geography**. Not template.

📖 *School List ch. · ~line 3072*

TIP 5, 6 & 7

5 Deposit traps.

Gray: *"DO deposits can be very large and non-refundable — capable of handcuffing you to one school."*

Check deposit $ before committing.

6 Faster verify.

AACOMAS averages **2 weeks** vs AMCAS 4. Submit early May → verified by June 1 → in front of schools June 26.

First transmit = June 26, 2026.

7 Slots unlimited.

AACOMAS lets you list more than 15. Don't dump. Gray: *"consistency beats total hours."* Use the extra room for your **MA year + Marsico + Med Anth**.

Quality > quantity. Same.

YOUR NUMBERS, BY THE NUMBERS

Well above every DO median

CUMULATIVE GPA

3.88

▲ +0.34 vs DO median 3.54

SCIENCE GPA

3.80

▲ +0.32 vs DO median 3.48

MCAT · 94%ILE

517

▲ +13 vs DO median 504

PAID CLINICAL HRS

1,000+

▲ Cycle 1: 0 · Medi-Weightloss MA

MCAT distribution · DO matriculants 2025

YOUR DO LIST

14 schools.

Ranked by fit, not reputation.

Every row has been Canadian-verified from the school's own admissions page.

THE LIST AT A GLANCE

#	SCHOOL	LOCATION	DEADLINE	YOUR HOOK
⭐	**MSUCOM**	East Lansing, MI	Dec 1	Canadian Initiative + MI home-state
2	**Marian WCOM**	Indianapolis, IN	Dec 1	Underserved mission + Med Anth alignment
3	**KCU-COM**	Kansas City, MO	Nov 1	Large class, Canadian-friendly, strong match
4	**NSU-KPCOM**	Ft. Lauderdale, FL	Jan 2	Huge class, diverse, Canadians matriculate yearly
5	**LECOM Bradenton**	Bradenton, FL	Mar 1	Lowest COA, PBL pathway option
6	**CCOM · Midwestern**	Downers Grove, IL	Dec 1	Midwest flagship, strong research ties
7	**RVUCOM**	Parker, CO	Feb 1	Canadian-eligible · rural/mountain medicine
8	**AZCOM · Midwestern**	Glendale, AZ	Dec 1	Southwest flagship, strong match
9	**RowanSOM**	Stratford, NJ	Dec 1	Civic mission · Canadians historically present
10–14	WesternU · WCUCOM · UNECOM · LUCOM · MCOM	CA / MS / ME / VA / GA	varies	Breadth — mission fit per school

SCHOOL #1

MSUCOM — East Lansing, MI

WHY THIS IS #1

Canadian Initiative Program — ~25 seats reserved for Canadians since 2011. Full-tuition scholarship. You are **literally** their target applicant.

YOUR MICHIGAN NARRATIVE

Farmington Hills childhood → Dr. Godbole → Oakland County primary care exposure. "Why MSU" essay writes itself.

BY THE NUMBERS

Median GPA	3.60
Median MCAT	507
Your margin	+0.28 GPA · +10 MCAT
AACOMAS deadline	Dec 1, 2026
Supplemental	Jan 5, 2027

Submit this one *first*.

SCHOOL #2

Marian WCOM — Indianapolis, IN

MISSION MATCH

Catholic, Franciscan values — *service to the underserved, whole-person dignity*. Your **Medical Anthropology** training on cultural humility + the Surat family-medicine legacy maps directly.

STORY TO DEPLOY

Medi-Weightloss + Med Anth "Hmong & Azande" papers — specific example of meeting patients in their *cultural frame*, not just their chart.

KEY DATA

Median GPA	3.56
Median MCAT	506
Int'l policy	Canadian-eligible
AACOMAS deadline	Dec 1, 2026

TOP PICKS AFTER THE TOP 2

KCU-COM

KANSAS CITY, MO

Large class (≈290). Generous to Canadians. Mission: primary care + underserved. Median **3.58 / 506**.

DEADLINE · NOV 1

NSU-KPCOM

FT. LAUDERDALE, FL

Very large (≈230), diverse, Canadians matriculate every year. Strong community health orientation. **3.54 / 504**.

DEADLINE · JAN 2

RVUCOM

PARKER, CO

Canadian-eligible. Rural / mountain / frontier medicine focus. **3.57 / 505**. Medi-Weightloss fits rural primary care pipeline.

DEADLINE · FEB 1

RowanSOM

STRATFORD, NJ

Public university DO. Civic mission, **strong Canadian-student history**, one of the oldest DO schools. **3.56 / 506**.

DEADLINE · DEC 1

THE REST OF THE LIST

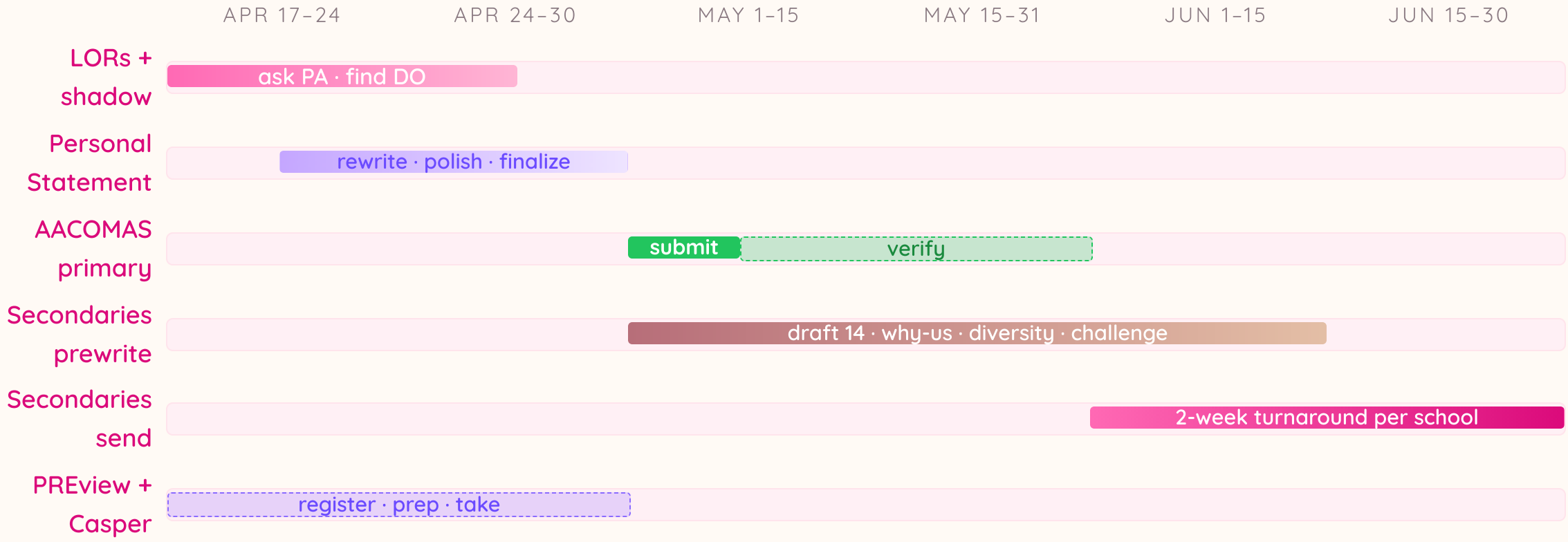
LECOM Bradenton	Bradenton, FL	Lowest COA on list. PBL or lecture pathway. **Best financial fit** if cost becomes decisive.
CCOM · Midwestern	Downers Grove, IL	Midwest flagship DO. Strong research ties — Marsico story plays well.
AZCOM · Midwestern	Glendale, AZ	Southwest twin of CCOM. Canadians eligible. **3.58 / 506**.
WesternU COMP	Pomona, CA	Interprofessional campus. Strong urban underserved pipeline.
WCUCOM	Hattiesburg, MS	William Carey — rural / faith-adjacent. Smaller, mission-driven.
UNECOM	Biddeford, ME	Primary care / rural New England. Mission: community medicine.
LUCOM	Lynchburg, VA	Faith-based. Verify fit carefully. Lower median stats — yield-protection watch.
MCOM	Moultrie, GA	New-ish DO school · rural GA focus. Good breadth pick.

6-WEEK SPRINT

Submit early June.

Here's the week-by-week.

WEEK-BY-WEEK PLAN



This week (Apr 17–24): email Dr. Schworer → ask PA/NP at Medi-Weightloss → register PREview → start looking for a DO to shadow.

INTERVIEW CHEAT SHEET

"Why osteopathic medicine?"

❌ WHAT GRAY ROASTS

"I definitely believe in the holistic approach to medicine. I want to view the patient in that holistic view... it's more common with the DO practice."

The word "holistic" without a story behind it = cliché.

✅ YOUR ANSWER

"My grandfather practiced medicine in Surat. He knew every patient's *family, work, and context*. When I studied **Medical Anthropology** at UNC, I learned why that produces better outcomes. At Medi-Weightloss, I watched the PA run the same kind of visit — ten minutes of body, ten of life. A DO education doesn't just permit that approach. It requires it."

AND IF THEY ASK: "WHY DO WITH A 517?"

"Because fit matters more than rank. I picked schools whose mission I can name — yours, specifically, is *[X specific phrase from their mission]*. That's the education I want." (Then name a program, faculty, or curriculum feature — never location, never ranking.)

MONEY REALITIES · CANADIAN TRACK

TUITION RANGE

$62–85K / yr

COA ≈ $85–110K/yr all-in.

ESCROW REALITY

1–4 yrs

Most US schools require Canadian students to **pre-fund tuition in escrow**. Confirm per school.

MSUCOM CANADIAN INITIATIVE

Full tuition

Why MSUCOM sits at **#1** — the scholarship alone changes the math.

Open question: Have you confirmed escrow + Canadian loan access with each school? This is the question that *actually* narrows your final acceptance decision. Starts mattering October 2026 when interviews land.

CYCLE 1 → CYCLE 2

What broke, and how it's fixed.

CYCLE 1 · WHAT BROKE	CYCLE 2 · WHAT'S FIXED
Zero paid clinical hours	**1,000+ hrs** Medi-Weightloss MA
No clinical LOR	**PA/NP letter** — primary clinical LOR
21 MD apps · 0 DO	MD + DO · **dual-track**
Recycled essays across schools	School-specific essays, Story Menu
Late submission	**Early June** target submit
Hospice listed (0 hours, never assigned)	Hospice removed · new activities added

Same seed. New stories. Better list.

You got this.

Same seed. New story. Better list.

Grandfather in Surat · Medical Anthropology · Marsico Lung

Medi-Weightloss MA · Farmington Hills

— fourteen schools that want exactly that.